

Some Cool Calc Tricks for Indian Taxpayers

If you do not consider yourself a Calc or Excel expert but must do your taxes in a spreadsheet, then these cool tricks can help you a great deal.



The financial year ended in March and everyone with taxable income must file IT returns by July this year. I opened a new bank account last year and it came with a new demat (share-trading) account. Rather than just shovel numerous lists of transactions from my bank and demat accounts to my tax consultant, I decided to put all that data in one spreadsheet before sending it to him.

My experience with spreadsheets ended with Lotus 1-2-3 in the 90s so working with Calc threw several challenges. Here is how I addressed them.

IF function — for conditional formulae

Some fixed deposits make interest payments at a regular interval (monthly, quarterly, half-yearly or yearly) while others pay cumulative interest only at

maturity. How do I make a column for monthly interest payments for a list that contains both types of deposits? If the amount paid back by a fixed deposit at maturity is the same as the amount invested at the beginning, then it would have paid interest at regular intervals. If the amount paid back at maturity is much greater than the amount invested at the beginning, then obviously, it must be a cumulative fixed deposit.

Deposit #	Amount invested (Rs)	Amount at maturity (Rs)	Number of years	Rate of interest	Monthly payout
234234234341	20000	25525	5	6%	=IF(B2=C2, B2*E2/12,0)
234234234342	20000	20000	5	5.5%	=IF(B3=C3, B3*E3/12,0)
234234234343	20000	28314	5	6.2%	=IF(B4=C4, B4*E4/12,0)
234234234344	20000	20000	5	7%	=IF(B5=C5, B5*E5/12,0)

F2 fx Σ ▾ = =IF(B2=C2, B2*E2/12,0)						
	A	B	C	D	E	F
1	Deposit #	Amount invested	Amount at maturity	Years	Rate	Monthly payout
2	234234234341	₹20,000.00	₹25,525.00	5	6%	₹0.00
3	234234234342	₹20,000.00	₹20,000.00	5	5.5%	₹91.67
4	234234234343	₹20,000.00	₹28,314.00	5	6.2%	₹0.00
5	234234234344	₹20,000.00	₹20,000.00	5	7%	₹116.67

Figure 1: Demo of IF